

Ilayda B. Onder

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Texas A&M University, College Station, TX
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science August 2024 – Present

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University, State College, PA
Ph.D. in Political Science 2024

Koc University, Istanbul, Turkey
M.A. in International Relations 2018
B.A. in International Relations 2016

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Onder, Ilayda B. 2026. "A Principal-Agent Theory and Network Analysis of High-End Cooperation Among Militant Groups." Accepted Pending Replication, *Political Science Research and Methods*.

Amjad, Maria, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. "Commanders of the Mujahideen: Introducing the Jihadist Leaders Dataset." Forthcoming, *Journal of Peace Research*.

Onder, Ilayda B., and Mark Berlin. 2025. "How Statements of Denial by Armed Actors Shape Public Perceptions and Emotions." *Political Psychology*.

Onder, Ilayda B., Nazli Avdan, and Aaron M. Hoffman. 2025. "Credit Claims and the Survival Rates of Terrorist Organizations." *International Interactions* 51(6): 1050–1066.

Onder, Ilayda B. 2025. "How Civilian Loyalties Shape Rebel-led Victimization of Rebel Constituencies." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(4): 701–730.

Loyle, Cyanne E., and **Ilayda B. Onder**. 2024. "The Legacies of Rebel Rule in South-east Turkey." *Comparative Political Studies* 57(11): 1771–1803.

Onder, Ilayda B. 2023. "Target Hardening and Non-State Armed Groups' Target Selection: Evidence from India." *Terrorism and Political Violence* 36(8): 1105–1126.

Onder, Ilayda B. 2023. "Signaling Resolve through Credit-claiming." *International Interactions* 49(5): 755–784.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

*Indicates graduate student co-author.

"Beyond Outbidding: Armed Group Responses to Transnational Jihadist Competition." (with Mark Berlin) R&R, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*.

"Leadership Succession and Militant Extra-Lethal Violence." (with Mark Berlin and Joshua Fawcett Weiner) R&R, *Journal of Global Security Studies*.

"Rebels Caught Between Needs and Norms." Under Review.

"Rebel Internal Governance." (with Hongbi Choi*) Under Review.

"Rebel Wartime Lobbying in the United States." (with Yu Bin Kim) Under Review.

"When Constituencies Unite, Recruitment Competition Divides." Under Review.

"Populism and Counterterrorism Preferences." (with James Piazza) Under Review.

"Performative Rebel Governance and Legibility: Evidence from Rebel Recruitment in Southeast Turkey." Under Review.

"The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict: Insights from the Kurdish Conflict." (with Mehmet Gurses, Aysegul Aydin, Ayse Betul Celik, Suren Jamal, Hamza Ahmed, Sirwan Renas, and Bahar Baser) Under Review.

WORKING PAPERS

**Indicates graduate student co-author.*

"Inter-Group Learning and Diffusion in Militant Alliances"

"Civilian Victimization by Governance-Oriented Rebels" (with Hongbi Choi*)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

**Indicates graduate student co-author. **Indicates undergraduate student co-author.*

"Part-Time Rebels"

"Promotion to Leadership Roles in Rebel Organizations"

"Repression and Rebel Recruitment" (with Muge Acarlar*)

"Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion" (with Mark Berlin and Kate Willey**)

"Delegation of Governance by Rebel Groups" (with Yu Bin Kim and Gidong Kim)

"Communication Technology, State Penetration, and Claims of Responsibility for Terrorism" (with Nazli Avdan and Aaron M. Hoffman)

"Information Communication Technology, Credit Claims, and the Survival of Terrorist Organizations" (with Nazli Avdan and Aaron M. Hoffman)

"Border Fortification and Rebel Cross-Border Movement" (with Jared Edgerton)

"Inter-Group Mobility in Conflict" (with Finn Klebe)

"Rebel Territorial Control and Kidnapping" (with Mark Berlin and Timothy Jones)

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Texas A&M University

Bush School Seed Grant Program, \$11,990 2025

Glasscock Faculty Research Fellowship, \$5,000 2025

Scowcroft Faculty Research Grant Award, \$2,400 2025

Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil War, University of York

Civil War Paths Fellow, Non-monetary 2024

The Pennsylvania State University

Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, \$1,000	2024
Summer Graduate Research Award, \$16,000	2020–2023
Outstanding Political Science Graduate Student, \$1,500	2022
RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2,000	2021
Program in Empirical International Relations Fellowship, Release Time	2021

TEACHING

Texas A&M University

Introduction to Political Science Research (Undergraduate)	Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Ethnic Conflict (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026

Ph.D. Advisory and Dissertation Committees

Erik Chi
Hongbi Choi
Muge Acarlar
Julia Reyes
Santiago Vidal Calvo
Nathaniel Williams

The Pennsylvania State University

International Relations Theory (Undergraduate)	Spring 2024
Quantitative Political Analysis (Undergraduate)	Fall 2023

**CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS**

American Political Science Association (APSA) Conference	2023, 2024
International Studies Association (ISA) Conference	2021–2026
Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2023
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference	2019, 2023
NYU-CESSE Experimental Political Science Conference	2024
Online Peace Science Colloquium	2021
Peace Science Society (International) Conference	2020, 2021, 2023, 2025
Political Networks Online Colloquium	2023
Texas Triangle IR Conference	2025, 2026

**INVITED TALKS
AND WORKSHOPS**

New Frontiers in Research on Terrorism and Civil Wars University of Houston	March 2025
The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict Peace Science Conference, University of Central Florida	November 2025

SERVICE

Departmental Service

Graduate & Curriculum Committee, Texas A&M University	2024–Present
Advisory Committee, Penn State University	2023–2024
Grad Student Assoc. of Political Science, Penn State University	2019–2022

Workshop Organizer

Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop	2024–Present
Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop	2023–2024

Reviewer

American Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, Conflict Management and Peace Science, Global Change, Peace & Security, International Interactions, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Peace Research, Network Science, Palgrave Macmillan, Political Science Research and Methods, Security Studies

**PROFESSIONAL
ASSOCIATIONS**

American Political Science Association (APSA)
International Studies Association (ISA)
Peace Science Society (International)

Updated on January 16, 2026